Content Publishing and Knowledge Base SOP

Controlled publication workflow with operational steps, review gates, escalation and sample help content

Document ID	PSRO-SOP-002	Revision	0.1
Owner	Demo Content Operations	Status	Illustrative draft

Scope note: The Public Services Resource Office (PSRO) is an invented organization. All assets, personas, metrics, evidence IDs, and review outcomes in this document are synthetic. No federal agency approved or used this procedure.

Purpose, scope and responsibility

This illustrative SOP governs creation, maintenance, retirement and emergency correction of PSRO internal and public information. It does not supersede a real agency record schedule, authority-to-operate boundary, accessibility procedure, or procurement requirement.

Role	Accountability
Requestor	Submits change request and intended user outcome
Technical Writer	Maintains controlled draft, citations and review evidence
Subject-matter expert	Verifies factual and operational accuracy
Accessibility reviewer	Conducts prescribed document/web accessibility tests
Content approver	Authorizes release and exceptions; not the author alone
Web administrator	Publishes, records version, checks redirects and search results

Standard procedure

1. Open a content request: record ticket, asset ID, audience, requested change, rationale, target date, and authoritative source.
2. Classify urgency. Safety, legal, accessibility-blocking, or materially incorrect public guidance is escalated to the content lead immediately and handled under agency-specific emergency procedures.
3. Confirm the authoritative owner and obtain a process walkthrough; document triggering events, user actions, system states, exceptions, and escalation routes.
4. Draft plain-language instructions in a controlled repository. Use semantic Word headings, numbered tasks, descriptive link text, meaningful tables and accessible alternatives.
5. Peer review for structure, consistency and findability; resolve each comment individually in a versioned review log.
6. SME verifies steps and decision points; accessibility reviewer conducts applicable tests using the approved method and records test scope, failures, fixes, and retest status.
7. If a critical accessibility or factual issue remains unresolved, block publication and escalate. Any formal exception follows the actual organization’s authorized process.
8. Approver records decision, revision, effective date, and release audience; publisher checks links, metadata, document accessibility evidence, and redirects.
9. After publication, test the page and top associated searches; monitor feedback for 30 days and reopen the ticket if findings recur.
10. On retirement, record retention/records decisions, update inbound links, redirects, and the asset register.

Controlled review and approval record

Gate	Required evidence	Block condition
Accuracy	Source citation + SME signoff	Conflicting or unverified instructions
Accessibility	Test record including manual checks	Unresolved material barrier
UX / search	Navigation and keyword review	Misleading title/metadata
Release	Revision + authorizing approval	Missing authorization or uncontrolled draft

Fictional example: LIB-007 repeats LIB-002 scheduling guidance. The writer logs the duplication, confirms with the scheduling SME, prepares a redirect, updates search synonyms, validates the link and files the retirement record. The old page is not removed before an approved source-of-truth decision.

Sample knowledge base article: Finding and downloading a resource

11. Open the Resource Library and identify the search field labeled “Search resources.”
12. Enter a plain-language term such as “eligibility” or “appointment”; results update without requiring a mouse.
13. Use the Category and File type controls to narrow results, or choose “All categories” to reset a filter.
14. Read the result title, format, and revision date before opening the selected resource.
15. If no results appear, use the suggested alternate terms or contact the accessibility/help team using the provided support route.

FAQ: “Why is a document missing?” It may be under review, retired, or pending accessibility remediation. Do not use an outdated copy; ask the content team for the approved version.

Reference basis and limitations

Primary reference: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/ . Additional source links and applicability are documented in review/REFERENCE_REGISTER.md.

Compliance note: Section 508 applies to covered federal ICT; WCAG 2.0 A/AA is incorporated by reference in the revised standards. WCAG 2.2 is noted only as complementary guidance. Automated checks do not establish full conformance. DHS Trusted Tester certification is not claimed.

Release controls and records-management addendum

Standards review: November 3, 2026. These additional controls and verification expectations are recommendations or conditional obligations for real federal systems; they are not evidence that the fictional PSRO system is approved, tested or compliant.

Records and retention checkpoint

Before retirement, redirect, replacement or deletion, check agency records policies and NARA-approved schedules; preserve required site snapshots, document versions and review/approval evidence. Archiving is not equivalent to immediate authorized destruction.

Accessible-document release gate

For content within covered federal Section 508 scope, determine web versus non-web document method. Complete prescribed checks of semantic headings, reading order, tagged PDF structure, meaningful links, tables, images, forms and other applicable criteria. Record tester, method/version, date, artifact, findings and verification. Automated checks alone cannot establish conformance.

User feedback and privacy review

Before adding real web forms or public surveys, consult the privacy team and determine whether the Paperwork Reduction Act and OMB clearance requirements apply. Use approved telemetry and avoid sharing unredacted user messages or identifying data in public documentation.

External publishing security

Require permission checks, authorized publishing identities, version control, and validated links. An actual agency platform would also require security authorization and technical-team approval; the offline prototype has no such approval.

Primary references for this addendum

- Section 508 Revised Standards: https://www.access-board.gov/ict/
- Electronic Document Testing Baseline: https://ictbaseline.access-board.gov/document-baselines/
- Federal Document Testing: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/
- OMB M-23-22: https://digital.gov/resources/delivering-digital-first-public-experience
- NARA Web Records: https://www.archives.gov/records-mgmt/policy/managing-web-records.html
- PRA and OMB Approval: https://www.reginfo.gov/public/jsp/Utilities/faq.jsp